Hsinchu Qionglin Wafer Technology Research Center

Although Qionglin Township is close to Hsinchu City and the Hsinchu Science Park, its population is still quite small. For example, Zhubei City, which is also near the Science Park, has about 220,000 people, while Qionglin has only about 20,000. This shows that Qionglin has not grown much despite the development of the high-tech industry nearby. Qionglin is also facing an aging population. About 21.3% of its population is aged 65 or older. From 2018 to 2025, Qionglin's population increased by only 1.8%, while young people aged 15 to 24 make up only about 9.6% of the population. Compared with Zhubei, Qionglin has fewer restaurants and shopping centers, so it is less attractive to young people. There are also fewer places for young people to spend their free time, such as entertainment facilities, sports centers, and other social spaces. Because of this, many young people may choose to live in Hsinchu City or Zhubei instead of Qionglin, even if they work in the nearby high-tech industry.

Another problem is that many young people leave smaller towns when they become adults. They often move to larger cities for better education, more job opportunities, and a more convenient lifestyle. When young people leave, the average age of the local population becomes higher. At the same time, there are fewer young families and children living in the area. This can also affect local schools, businesses, and community activities. Therefore, Qionglin needs more than just population growth. It needs new opportunities and better living conditions that can encourage young people to stay or move to the area.

To solve this problem, I am going to create an expanded wafer technology research center. I also plan to build a training center for TSMC employees on Wenshan Road. I chose this location because it allows employees to reach TSMC more quickly. Its location can also make it easier for workers to travel between Qionglin and the Science Park. The training center could provide courses related to semiconductor technology, workplace skills, and professional development. Young people who are interested in the semiconductor industry could also have opportunities to receive training and learn more about possible careers.

The center will provide more job and training opportunities for young people. Instead of only attracting people who already work in the semiconductor industry, the center could also help students and new workers develop the skills they need to enter the industry. For example, the center could cooperate with universities and technical schools in Hsinchu. Students could visit the center, attend workshops, or participate in internships. This would allow them to gain practical experience before entering the workforce. After completing their training, some of them could choose to work in the Science Park while living in Qionglin.

Housing is also an important part of this plan. If more young workers move to Qionglin, there should be enough affordable housing for them. I would like to include new apartments or young-worker housing near the research and training center. These homes could be designed for young workers, young couples, and small families. Affordable housing would make it easier for workers to live close to their jobs instead of choosing to live in Zhubei or Hsinchu City.

Transportation should also be improved. Since many workers would need to travel between Qionglin and the Science Park, convenient transportation would be very

important. The project could include shuttle buses between the training center, major transportation stations, and the Science Park. Better roads, bus services, and bicycle paths could also make it easier for people to travel around Qionglin. If transportation becomes more convenient, people may be more willing to live in Qionglin even if they work outside the township.

This project could also bring more businesses and services to Qionglin. As more young people move to the area, there may be more demand for restaurants, shopping centers, cafés, supermarkets, gyms, and other facilities. Local businesses could benefit from the increase in population. New businesses could also create additional jobs for local residents. Over time, this could create a positive cycle: more people create more demand for businesses, and more businesses make Qionglin more attractive to new residents.

In addition, I would like to create more public spaces for young people and families. For example, the area around the center could include parks, walking paths, sports facilities, and community spaces. These places could give residents opportunities to exercise, relax, and meet other people. A more active community could make young people feel that Qionglin is not only a place to work, but also a place to live and build a family.

The project could also benefit older residents. Although the main goal is to attract young people, the development should not ignore the existing population. New medical services, transportation, shops, and community facilities could make daily life easier for older people. Young and older residents could also interact through community activities. In this way, the project could help different generations live together instead of focusing only on young workers.

Environmental protection should also be considered. Qionglin has a more rural environment than Hsinchu City and Zhubei, so development should not completely change its existing character. The new center should use energy-efficient buildings and include green spaces. Trees, parks, and green areas could be included around the center. The project should also try to reduce traffic pollution and protect important natural and agricultural areas. The goal is to develop Qionglin while keeping its local environment and character.

If the center creates new job opportunities and attracts more young workers and their families, Qionglin's population could increase over the next 5–10 years. However, population growth should not be the only goal. The project should also improve the quality of life for both new and existing residents. More jobs, better transportation, more housing, and better public facilities could make Qionglin a more attractive place to live.

In the future, I hope more people can build their careers in the semiconductor industry while living in Qionglin. I also hope that young people who grew up in Qionglin will have more reasons to stay instead of moving away. With more job opportunities and better living conditions, Qionglin could become a place where young people can work, live, and raise their families.

Overall, the Hsinchu Qionglin Wafer Technology Research Center is not only a plan for developing the semiconductor industry. It is also a plan for improving the community and creating a better future for Qionglin. By connecting technology, employment, housing, transportation, businesses, and public facilities, the project could help reduce the problem of population decline and aging. In the long term, I

hope Qionglin can become a more active, convenient, and people-friendly place while still keeping its local character.